

“Mirror & Moonlight”

The Side No One Reads
A Poem Book

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"The First Page"

I was a whisper in the winds of fate,
A prayer my parents would softly narrate.
Then one bright day, the skies did sing,
And I arrived—wrapped in blessing,
breathing spring.

Their eyes held stars, their hearts beat
fast,

A moment so pure, too precious to pass.
Their world had shifted, time stood still,
For love had bloomed without a will.

In tiny fists, I held their dreams,
Cried my song in infant screams.

A cradle rocked, the world felt right—
My life began in golden light.

From lullabies to morning rays,
I danced into the coming days.

And thus began this wondrous flight—
My story inked in joy and light.

"She Was Born"

She was born like dawn — soft, pure, divine,
With eyes full of stardust, a soul that would
shine.

But whispers rose where blessings should be,
Not joy, but silence — heavy, uneasy.
The walls sighed low, the faces turned cold,
As if a daughter was a burden to hold.
No sweets were shared, no skies were lit,
A quiet ache the cradle would sit.
But she smiled — unaware, untouched by
scorn,

A warrior wrapped in pink was born.
Her hands were tinay, her dreams were wide,
Yet the world placed limits by her side.
Still, her laughter fought the night,
She grew like fire — fierce and bright.
Not a burden, not a cost,
But a galaxy they nearly lost.

“We Were Just Children”

We were just children — wild and free,
Chasing clouds and climbing trees.
Pocketing marbles, stealing time,
Drawing worlds with crayon and rhyme.
We laughed at puddles, feared the dark,
Made paper boats and named each park.
Our biggest secret? A candy stash,
And dreams that sparkled in every splash.
No masks we wore, no roles to play,
Just truth in every word we'd say.
We cried, forgave, then played again,
Friends weren't faces — they were rain.
Our world was small, but hearts were wide,
With scraped-up knees and fearless pride.
We didn't need much — just sky and
ground,
A swing, a story, a love unbound.

“Raised to Be Strong”

They said, “Be strong, don’t ever cry,”
“Boys don’t break, they only try.”

So I locked my tears behind a grin,
And wore a mask I buried in.

They taught me pride in silent pain,
To never fold, to never explain.

I laughed aloud but inside, small—
A boy too young to carry it all.

No lullabies when fear would creep,
No gentle arms to help me sleep.

Only echoes of “Man up, be tough,”
As if my heart was not enough.

I played the part the world had cast,
But lost some innocence too fast.

Still, through the cracks, a truth did grow:
Strength is soft, and now I know.

“The Glass Rules”

She learned to walk, not too loud,
To shrink herself within the crowd.
Spoke in whispers, smiled with care—
A princess, yes, but trapped in air.
“Sit straight, dress right, lower your gaze,”
Her childhood passed in silent haze.
While boys ran wild, free to roam,
She was taught that shame starts at
home.
They clipped her wings to keep her safe,
Told her, “A good girl knows her place.”
Not too bold, not too free—
A perfect blend of quiet and “she.”
But fire doesn’t ask for grace,
It burns through every tight-laced space.
She wrote her story between the lines,
In stolen hours and secret signs.

"Bell Rings and Forever Things"

We wore the same shirts, different dreams,
Laughed in corridors, plotted in teams.
Backbencher hearts and chalk-stained
hands,
Ruled a kingdom of wooden desks and
banned plans.
Whispers during lectures, codes in books,
Silent giggles and exchanged looks.
Lunchbox trades and stolen fries,
Truth or dare beneath classroom skies.
They weren't just friends — they were our
days,
In silly fights and endless plays.
One pen, one bench, one goal to pass,
One shared secret scribbled on glass.
Marks faded, but not the nicknames,
Nor the bicycle races and cricket games.
We grew up, yes — but some part stayed,
In that dusty field where memories played.

"The Weight I Never Chose"

They handed me books, not dreams or wings,

Told me to solve, not to feel things.

"First rank matters," they softly screamed,
And crushed the boy who once had dreamed.

Marks became my worth, not my name,
Success was a scoreboard, not a flame.

I learned to smile with sleepless eyes,
And hide my fear in practiced lies.

"What will people say?" was carved in stone,

A voice that echoed when I felt alone.

They built a race, then blamed the slow,
And buried hearts they'd never know.

No one asked what made me burn,

What pages I loved, what paths I yearned.

Only numbers, only noise—

No space for scars in silent boys.

“Between Cafes and Credits”

We entered with ID cards and shaky hearts,

New books in hands, unsure starts.

The gates were tall, the dreams were wide,

And life began on the other side.

Timetables faded, chai stalls grew,

Canteen gossip and friendships new.

Sleepless nights before the test,

Group studies where we mostly jest.

From bunked lectures to freshers' nights,

To crushes hidden and silent fights.

Some found love, some found pain,

Some lost themselves, then rose again.

Laughter echoed in hostel halls,

Hearts healed over mess food calls.

We found ourselves, piece by piece,

In broken dreams and moments of peace.

“The Way She Exists”

She walks in like a whisper,
Not loud — just felt.
Like the breeze before rain,
Or the pause where hearts melt.
Her laughter isn't thunder,
But it echoes just the same,
And somehow every ordinary thing
Feels brighter when she came.
I notice things she doesn't hide,
But no one ever sees—
Like how she hums beneath her breath,
Or counts stars in idle breeze.
She's not perfect — thank God she's not,
But there's poetry in her flaws.
She's the kind who doesn't know her
worth,
And that's what gives me pause.

“Man Enough”

They said, “Be something, make us proud,”
So I wore a dream that spoke out loud.
But dreams aren’t light when they’re not
your own,
And I walked a path I’d never known.
“A man must earn, provide, succeed,”
As if my worth was just a need.
No room for fear, no time to fall,
Just rise and rise, or lose it all.
They cheered the ranks, the jobs, the pay,
But never asked, “Are you okay?”
Behind the suits and silent grind,
Was a boy with chaos in his mind.
I wasn’t weak, just deeply tired—
Of chasing roles I never desired.
Of smiling wide in crowded rooms,
While sinking deep in unseen gloom.

"More Than Enough"

They told her, "Dream big, the world is yours,"

Then built her walls and locked the doors.
"Chase your goals, but know your place,"
In every step, a double face.

Degrees in hand, but eyes still scan,
"Will your in-laws let you work once you're a woman?"

She walks a tightrope, learns to bend,
But her fire isn't something they can end.
"Too bold, too late, too much, too fast..."
They weigh her down with every past.
If she wins, "She must've had a guide,"
If she breaks, "Well, girls aren't built for the ride."

She isn't asking for easy roads,
Just equal worth in heavy loads.
She dreams like him, works even more,
Yet must smile through every war.

“The Reckless Beautiful Days”

We weren't grown, not really kids,
Just hearts with dreams and half-done
lids.

Our phones were full, our minds were free,
We lived in now, not what would be.
Crushes hit like crashing waves,
Secrets sworn and friends we'd save.
One heartbreak felt like the end of time,
Yet we healed with memes and Pepsi lime.
Bunked a class, blamed the rain,
Wrote love letters we'd never explain.
Late-night calls, "Are you asleep?"
While hiding from parents who'd never
peep.

We made mistakes with fearless pride,
Laughed too hard, and sometimes cried.
But every scar from those wild years—
Turned into strength or disappeared.

“Letters Left Unsent”

I wrote you a letter I never sent,
Folded in thoughts, sealed with regret.
It spoke of nights I couldn't sleep,
And all the silence I chose to keep.

One was to Maa — about that day,
I said, “I’m fine,” but I wasn’t okay.
Another for a friend who disappeared,
When I needed them most, they just...
cleared.

There’s one to her — the one I loved,
I told her everything, but not enough.
I said, “I’m proud,” “I’m glad you’re free,”
But never confessed she still lived in me.

I wrote to my younger self too,
“Forgive the world for not loving you.”
“You’ll grow, you’ll glow, but you’ll bleed
first,

And sometimes kindness will feel like a
curse.”

“Friends Who Faded”

No storm, no slam of a closing door,
Just... fewer texts than there were before.
The laughter stopped echoing in our
threads,

And plans remained “someday” instead.
We didn’t fight — and that’s the truth,
We just grew out of each other’s youth.
Life changed routes we didn’t choose,
And in the shuffle, we both just... bruised.
I still see your birthday come and go,
And sometimes pause, but never show.
I wonder if you’d still laugh at that joke,
If you still wear black, or if you finally
broke.

We were once each other’s loudest name,
Now I scroll past yours without blame.
No anger left, no reason to pretend —
Some friendships don’t break,
they just quietly... end.

“The Girl Who Didn’t Speak”

She wasn't shy,
just trained to whisper.
Taught that silence is safer
than truth that might blister.
She knew the answers,
but let them pass.
Not because she didn't know—
but because she'd learned to come last.
She smiled when told,
“Speak only when asked,”
Her dreams folded neatly
in someone else's task.
She watched the world
with stories untold,
Her thoughts like fires
in chambers too cold.

“Boys Don’t Cry, But I Did”

They taught me early —

“Real men don’t cry.”

So I blinked back storms
and learned to lie.

I smiled through grief,
laughed through pain,
Clenched my fists
to silence the rain.

I said, “I’m fine,”
when I was undone,
Told jokes in groups,
but cried alone when it was done.

No one asked why my voice got small,
Why my replies stopped coming at all.
Because boys are bricks, not waves or
flame —

We break in silence and leave no name.

“Two Goodbyes, One Beginning”

She stood in red, wrapped in grace,
A thousand eyes, one unfamiliar place.
Her laughter soft, her hands were still,
A storm behind the silent will.

He stood in gold, with practiced smile,
Greeting faces, numb all the while.
Told to “be strong,” “be the man,”
Still wondering if he truly can.

She left a room that knew her scent,
The walls that watched her tears unspent.
He stepped away from careless days,
Into a life with structured ways.

They met as strangers, joined as two,
In rituals lit with marigold hue.
And everyone smiled, clapped, and cheered —

But none asked what they really feared.

“After the Fireworks”

The drums have stilled, the guests are gone,

The stage dismantled, the lights turned off.

She sits in silk she didn't choose,
In a room that still smells of strangers' perfume.

He lies beside, a heartbeat near,

Yet they both feel a kind of fear.

The laughter lingers in borrowed air,

But the silence now is hard to bear.

He wonders if this smile will stay,

She hopes her dreams won't drift away.

No fairy tale, no final scene —

Just morning tea and in-between.

He learns to read her quiet sighs,

She hides her tears behind goodbyes.

They speak in looks, they walk with care,

Still searching for a love that's there.

“Dreams on Rent”

Once, I dreamed in colors wild,
Of stories, stars, and being a child.
Now I chase numbers, tick boxes fast,
In a race where joy is always last.
I wanted art — I got Excel.

I wanted peace — I learned to sell.
The 9 to 5 feels more like 9 to never,
And my “one day” dreams? They left
forever.

I rent my time, lease my spark,
Smile in the light, break in the dark.
They say, “Grow up, that’s how it goes,”
But they never asked if I chose those
roads.

Every passion packed in dusty files,
Replaced by meetings and practiced
smiles.

“Maa Ke Pairon Ka Aangan”

Jab duniya ne mujhe thaka diya,
Main chupchaap maa ke paas ja baitha.
Uske pairon ke aangan mein
Na koi sawaal tha, na koi darr.
Wahan waqt ruk jaata tha,
Aur meri har haar chhup jaati thi.
Na koi resume, na koi rank,
Bas ek thali, ek haath, aur ek
muskuraahat.
Maa ne kabhi nahi poocha,
"Kitna kamaaya?"
Bas pucha —
"Khaana khaya?"
Jab bhi duniya ne mujhe tod diya,
Usne bina puchhe jod diya.
Uski choti si pooja ki thali mein
Mujhe apna poora vishwaas mil jaata tha.

“The Girl Who Chose Herself”

They taught her to shrink,
to smile small and say “yes.”
To pour herself into molds
that never fit her dress.
They handed her duties
wrapped as dreams,
Told her love meant silence,
and life came in routines.
But she —
she chose otherwise.
She walked out of lines,
with storms in her eyes.
No prince, no savior,
no waiting around.
She built her own peace
on trembling ground.

“The Boy Behind The Smile”

He walks in loud, with jokes to spare,
Lighting up rooms like he's never known
care.

“Always so chill,” they all believe,
Not knowing how well he learns to deceive.
He remembers birthdays, cracks the right
line,

The kind of friend who says, “I’m fine.”
But late at night, when curtains fall,
He stares at a ceiling that knows it all.
There are things he never speaks aloud —
Like the weight of being everyone’s cloud.
He lifts them all, one by one,
But forgets he’s heavy too, when day is
done.

His smile is a shield, not a sign of peace,

“When I Met Myself Again”

I found pieces of me
between old songs and evening tea,
in quiet walks without a goal,
and questions that whispered to my soul.
No applause, no grand return —
Just a heart that began to yearn
for less pretending, more truth,
and the softness I'd lost in youth.

I met myself
in the middle of doubt,
not fixed, not fearless —
just figuring it out.

The mirror didn't lie,
but I did, for years.
Wore borrowed smiles,
swallowed tears.

“Still Learning, Still Growing”

I've made peace with the cracks in my soul,

With the chapters that never made me whole.

I'm not perfect, polished, or wise —

But I show up with honest eyes.

I've unlearned more than I've learned,

Loved where I should have turned.

I've grown through rain, bloomed in pain,

And danced with loss like an old refrain.

I no longer chase the final draft,

I live in edits, and that's enough.

Some days I'm soft, some days I fall,

But I keep rising — that says it all.

Still asking, still breaking,

Still slowly awakening.

I'm not who I was yesterday —

And tomorrow?

I'll be even further away.

“Two Stories, One Life”

Life began the same —
a wail, a breath, a name.
But the paths we walked
were never quite the same.
She was taught to sit small,
he to stand tall.
She learned silence,
he learned not to fall.
He was told to be strong,
not to cry when things went wrong.
She was told to be kind,
even when it broke her mind.
He bore pressure on his chest,
to be the “man,” to be the best.
She bore whispers behind her back,
judged for dreams she dared to track.

“Jeene Ka Naam Zindagi”

Zindagi sirf kaam ke liye nahi hoti,
na hi sirf naam ke liye hoti.

Kabhi-kabhi bas jeene ke liye bhi
jeena zaroori hota hai.

Har waqt planning mat karo,
kuch pal beplaan bhi rehne do.

Har muskurahat ke peeche wajah kyun
ho?

Kabhi bas khushi ke liye bhi muskurao.

Paisa aayega,
sapne banenge —

Par waqt,
woh toh sirf ek baar jiyega.

Phone down karo,
chaand dekho.

List hatao,
doston se milo.

Zaroori nahi har baat post ho,
kuch lamhe sirf dil ke inbox mein raho. 27